

Mustafa Shoukat

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Prepared for: Staff AI Engineer — Teradata

I am applying for the Staff AI Engineer role at Teradata because it sits exactly where I have chosen to build my career: at the intersection of **enterprise data** and **trustworthy, production-grade AI**. Teradata has spent decades earning enterprises' trust with their most critical data. The frontier now is putting agentic and generative AI on top of that data safely, at scale, and with answers people can rely on — and that is the problem I have spent the last several years solving in production.

I have owned AI platform architecture end-to-end, not individual features. I designed and shipped **ByanRAG 2.2**, a multi-tenant, Arabic-first RAG platform deployed **on-premises inside regulated government networks**, with per-organization data isolation, a 5-level access-control hierarchy enforced on every endpoint, full audit logging, and a hybrid retrieval pipeline that returns **source-cited** answers. Alongside it, I built a **Claude-as-judge evaluation and fine-tuning pipeline** — with faithfulness and groundedness scoring and prompt-injection defenses — that took an Arabic LLM to **#1 on the AraGen Leaderboard**. I care as much about *proving* an AI system is correct and safe as about making it work, because that is what separates a demo from something an enterprise will run.

The technical leadership I bring is threefold. First, **architecture ownership**: I take systems from design through distributed, fault-tolerant deployment — Celery/Redis, containerization, nginx/TLS, and full Prometheus/Grafana/Loki observability — backed by a 600+ test suite and CI/CD. Second, **agentic systems at production quality**: LangGraph, CrewAI, and MCP orchestration with tool-calling and multi-step planning, applied to real workflows like automated government-contracting analysis. Third, **raising the people around me**: I set engineering standards for testing, deployment, and model integration, mentor engineers, have trained 150+ professionals, and contribute upstream to the tools our field depends on — LangChain, RAGAS, and Unstructured.

What draws me to this specific role is the **scale and seriousness** of the problem. I have built enterprise AI for government and regulated clients across Saudi Arabia, the UAE, the US, and the UK, where the requirements are exactly Teradata's: reliability, security, data consistency, and answers that hold up under scrutiny. A Staff role — where I can shape architecture decisions, mentor other engineers, and resolve the hard production problems — is the level at which I already operate and the level at which I want to contribute.

I would be glad to bring that experience to Teradata's AI platform, and to help build the next generation of AI products on top of the enterprise data your customers already trust you with.

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